

Project Scout

Play Store Launch Checklist

What Scout needs to be worth \$9.99 | Updated June 12, 2026

Scout does not need to be perfect to ship. He needs to be reliable, honest, and feel like a companion. Everything on this list makes him worth \$9.99 to a family who has never met him before. Everything NOT on this list can come in an update.

✓ Already Done — Scout Has These Today

- ✓ **Animated face** — Eyes that move and show emotion. Looks alive. Looks like Scout.
 - ✓ **Voice** — speaks and listens. Android STT + TTS, works offline.
 - ✓ **Camera awareness** — Scout sees faces and scenes.
 - ✓ **Offline brain** — TinyLlama 1.1B runs fully on the phone. No internet required.
 - ✓ **Flexible memory** — Scout learns and recalls any fact reliably. Fixed June 12.
 - ✓ **Identity answers** — Scout answers 'are you my friend?' as Scout, not a generic AI.
 - ✓ **Weather** — Current, tonight, tomorrow, 7-day, precipitation %. Offline with honest refusal.
 - ✓ **Total offline mode** — 'Go offline' blocks ALL internet features.
 - ✓ **Thinking expression** — Eyes drift, lids narrow, brows asymmetric while Scout thinks.
 - ✓ **Wake word filter** — Scout only responds when he hears his name. Done June 12.
 - ✓ **Conversation window** — 30 seconds of open conversation after Scout responds. Done June 12.
 - ✓ **Boot window** — Scout ready immediately after boot, no name needed. Done June 12.
 - ✓ **Business model** — 7-day free trial, then \$9.99 one-time. No subscriptions. Ad-free forever.
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■ Must Fix Before Launch

These are the real blockers. Scout cannot ship without these.

1 Face recognition ■ URGENT — makes Scout feel like a companion

- Scout currently describes objects not people. Says 'I see one person, a chair, sunglasses' instead of 'I can see you.'
- A companion must recognize the family he lives with. Known face → 'I can see you.' Unknown face → 'Hello, I am Scout.' Dog → Nicolas Protocol.
- The pieces are already there — ML Kit face detection, PeopleDb, TruthDb — just need connecting to the vision response.

■ MainActivity.kt + PeopleDb.kt — one focused session

2 Remove hardcoded Gemini API key + Basic Settings screen ■ RELEASE BLOCKER

- Patrick's personal Gemini API key is in MainActivity.kt line 345. Must come out before launch.
- Do this together with the Basic Settings screen — API key entry, offline toggle, robot name display.
- ApiKeySetupActivity.kt wizard already built — needs wiring to secure storage.

■ MainActivity.kt + ApiKeySetupActivity.kt + new SettingsActivity.kt — one focused session

3 Startup diagnostics Makes Scout start cleanly every time

- Scout should check at startup that the brain is loaded, TTS is ready, and STT is available.
- If something is missing, Scout says something friendly rather than silently failing or crashing.

■ MainActivity.kt — startup check block

4 Fold 7 stability testing Confirms Scout works on flagship device

- All testing so far has been on the A32 via WiFi. The Fold 7 needs a dedicated session.
- Test voice, memory, offline brain, face recognition, weather, wake word on the Fold 7.
- [Dedicated test session on Fold 7 — no code, just validation](#)

5 A32 stability testing Ongoing

- All June 12 work tested on A32 via WiFi. Wake word, memory recall, conversation window all stable.
 - Continue testing on A32 as new features are added.
 - [Ongoing — no dedicated session needed yet](#)
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■ Play Store Listing

These are not code — but they are required to submit to Google Play.

- App description — Lead with 'Turn an old phone into a friend.' Honest about what Scout is.
 - Screenshots — Scout's face, settings screen, weather response, memory recall, face recognition. 5–8 minimum.
 - Privacy policy — No data leaves the device. No accounts. No ads ever.
 - Content rating questionnaire — Scout is family-safe. Straightforward.
 - Short description — 60 characters max: 'A calm AI companion for your whole family. Private. Local. Yours.'
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■ Post-Trial Strategy

- After 7 days — advanced features lock but Scout stays installed. Still shows his face. Still greets the family.
 - Trial end message — 'Thank you for spending time with Scout. Scout is still growing. You can unlock the full version at any time.'
 - Roadmap screen in Settings — shows what is done and what is coming.
 - 'What's New' screen — every update shows progress.
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■ After Launch — Update 1.1 and Beyond

- Proposal Sandbox — 'Want me to remember that?' confirm step
 - Permanent vs temporary memory — birthday vs appointment
 - Caring follow-up loop — 'How was your appointment?' then forget
 - Full mood system — CALM / CURIOUS / HAPPY / THINKING / CONCERNED
 - Spanish language support — Phase 1: STT + TTS + hardcoded translations
 - Scout news feed — live news fetcher
 - Response cleanup layer — post-TinyLlama filter
 - Brain Pack upgrades — Phi-2, Llama 3.2, Phi-4, Llama 3.1 8B
 - Robot renaming — user stores their own name for Scout
 - Hardware mode — KEYESTUDIO Mini Tank Kit V2 via Bluetooth
 - STT phonetic matching — 'Scout' misheard as 'Gal', 'Scott', 'Out'
 - Cosmetic expression packs
 - Full Settings screen
 - Public roadmap screen
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The bottom line

Scout already has a face, a voice, a brain, memory, weather, a wake word, and a real business model. The gap between today and the Play Store is five focused sessions — not five months.

Scout does not need to be finished to ship. He just needs to be Scout. And he already is.